

HSK 3 Grammar & Syntax

Complete Pattern Reference

汉语水平考试三级·语法句型指南

HSK 3.0 Standard · Words 501–1000

Pinyin · Examples · Usage Notes · Contrast Pairs

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Pattern 1 · The 把 Construction (Disposal) 把字句

Structure: Subject + 把 + Object + Verb + Complement/Result

Meaning: Subject disposes of / does something to the object

把 front-loads the object before the verb to emphasise what is done to it and what happens as a result. The verb MUST be followed by a complement, result, or directional element — a bare verb after 把 is ungrammatical.

请把窗户关上。

Qǐng bǎ chuānghu guān shàng.

Please close the window.

我把作业做完了。

Wǒ bǎ zuòyè zuò wán le.

I finished the homework.

他把书放在桌子上了。

Tā bǎ shū fàng zài zhuōzi shàng le.

He put the book on the table.

你把我的手机拿走了？

Nǐ bǎ wǒ de shǒujī ná zǒu le?

Did you take away my phone?

What CAN follow the verb in a 把 sentence

Result verb	把书读完	finish reading the book
Direction	把椅子搬过来	move the chair over here
在/到 + place	把书放在桌上	put the book on the table
给 + person	把信送给他	deliver the letter to him
了 alone	把饭吃了	eat up the food (imperative tone)

Negation and modals

Negation and modal verbs go BEFORE 把, never between 把 and the verb.

我没把作业做完。

Wǒ méi bǎ zuòyè zuò wán.

I didn't finish the homework.

你应该把房间打扫干净。

Nǐ yīnggāi bǎ fángjiān dǎsǎo gānjìng.

You should clean the room.

把 cannot be used with verbs of perception/cognition (看见, 知道, 认识, 喜欢, 觉得) or stative verbs. It requires an action that produces a tangible result on the object.

The object of 把 must be definite/specific — something both speaker and listener know about. You cannot say 把一本书读完 (把 + indefinite object). Use 读完了一本书 instead.

Pattern 2 · The 被 Passive Construction 被字句

Structure: Subject (receiver) + 被 + Agent
+ Verb + Complement

Meaning: The subject undergoes an action performed by the agent

被 marks the subject as the receiver of an action. Like 把, the verb must carry a complement or result — a bare verb is ungrammatical. The agent (doer) can be omitted when unknown or irrelevant.

我的手机被他拿走了。

Wǒ de shǒujī bèi tā ná zǒu le.

My phone was taken away by him.

作业被老师改好了。

Zuòyè bèi lǎoshī gǎi hǎo le.

The homework was corrected by the teacher.

窗户被风吹开了。

Chuānghu bèi fēng chuī kāi le.

The window was blown open by the wind.

蛋糕被吃完了。

Dàngāo bèi chī wán le.

The cake was eaten up. (agent omitted)

In Chinese, 被 sentences are typically used for undesirable or unexpected outcomes — this is the opposite of English passive, which is neutral. For positive or neutral passives, Chinese often uses an active construction instead.

被 vs. 让/叫/给: All can mark passive constructions colloquially. 让/叫 are informal; 给 is even more colloquial (dialectal). 被 is the standard written form.

Pattern 3 · 才 (cái): Only Then / Not Until 才

Structure: Context + 才 + Verb

Meaning: Action happens later/less than expected; 'only then'

才 encodes the speaker's expectation that something happened later, less, or with more difficulty than expected. This is the key contrast with 就, which signals earlier/faster/easier than expected.

他八点才来。

Tā bā diǎn cái lái.

He didn't come until 8. (late)

学了三年才能说流利。

Xué le sān nián cái néng shuō liúli.

It takes three whole years of study before you can speak fluently.

我才明白他的意思。

Wǒ cái míngbai tā de yìsi.

Only now do I understand what he meant.

才 vs. 就 — the expectation axis

他八点就来了。	He came at 8 — earlier than expected
他八点才来。	He came at 8 — later than expected
他只用了两天就完成了。	He finished in just two days — fast!
他用了两天才完成。	It took him two whole days to finish — slow/difficult

才 sentences describing past actions do NOT use 了 after the verb. Compare: 他八点就来了 (就 + 了 = fine) vs. 他八点才来 (才, no 了). Adding 了 after 才 makes the sentence sound unnatural.

Pattern 4 · 只有…才 vs. 只要…就 条件句

只有…才 — Necessary condition: 'only if…then'

Structure: 只有 + Condition + 才 + Result	Meaning: The condition is the ONLY way to achieve the result
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只有努力学习，才能通过考试。

Zhǐyǒu nǔlì xuéxí, cái néng tōngguò kǎoshì.

Only by studying hard can you pass the exam.

只有你来，他才高兴。

Zhǐyǒu nǐ lái, tā cái gāoxìng.

Only if you come will he be happy.

只要…就 — Sufficient condition: 'as long as…then'

Structure: 只要 + Condition + 就 + Result	Meaning: The condition is ENOUGH to guarantee the result
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只要你努力，就一定能成功。

Zhǐyào nǐ nǔlì, jiù yīdìng néng chénggōng.

As long as you work hard, you will definitely succeed.

只要天气好，我们就去爬山。

Zhǐyào tiānqì hǎo, wǒmen jiù qù páshān.

As long as the weather is good, we'll go hiking.

The critical distinction: 只有…才 = necessary condition (no other way works); 只要…就 = sufficient condition (this one way is enough). Think of it as: 只有 narrows down to one path; 只要 says one path is enough.

Pattern 5 · 如果…(就) — Conditional: If…Then 假设句

Structure: 如果 + Condition, (就) + Result

Meaning: Hypothetical condition and its consequence

如果 introduces a hypothesis. 就 in the result clause is optional but common. The subject can appear before or after 如果 depending on whether it applies to one or both clauses.

如果明天下雨，我们就不去了。

Rúguǒ míngtiān xià yǔ, wǒmen jiù bù qù le.

If it rains tomorrow, we won't go.

如果你有问题，可以问我。

Rúguǒ nǐ yǒu wèntí, kěyǐ wèn wǒ.

If you have questions, you can ask me.

如果他来的话，请告诉我。

Rúguǒ tā lái de huà, qǐng gàosu wǒ.

If he comes, please let me know.

的话 (dehuà) appended to the condition clause is a softer, more colloquial way to mark a conditional. 要是…就 is a more casual spoken synonym for 如果…就.

Pattern 6 · 不但…而且 — Not Only…But Also 递进句

Structure: 不但 + A, 而且 + B

Meaning: B adds on to or surpasses A; progressive relationship

不但…而且 expresses escalation — B is an additional, stronger, or more surprising fact layered on top of A. Both clauses share the same subject, which usually appears before 不但.

他不但会说中文，而且会写汉字。

Tā búdàn huì shuō Zhōngwén, érqiě huì xiě Hànzì.

He can not only speak Chinese, but also write characters.

这家饭馆不但便宜，而且好吃。

Zhè jiā fànguǎn búdàn piányi, érqiě hǎochī.

This restaurant is not only cheap, but also delicious.

With different subjects — add 也/还

不但老师喜欢他，同学们也喜欢他。

Búdàn lǎoshī xǐhuan tā, tóngxuémen yě xǐhuan tā.

Not only does the teacher like him, but classmates also like him.

When the two clauses have different subjects, 也 or 还 appears before the verb in the second clause. This distinguishes 不但…而且 (same subject) from 不但…也 (different subjects), though both are acceptable.

Pattern 7 · 除了…还/也 — Besides / Except 除了

除了…还/也 = 'in addition to' (inclusive)

Structure: 除了 + A, 还/也 + Verb B

Meaning: Apart from A, also B (A is included)

除了中文，我还学英文。

Chúle Zhōngwén, wǒ hái xué Yīngwén.

Besides Chinese, I also study English.

除了…以外, 都 = 'except' (exclusive)

Structure: 除了 + A + (以外), 都 + Verb

Meaning: Everyone/everything except A

除了他以外，大家都来了。

Chúle tā yǐwài, dàjiā dōu lái le.

Everyone came except him.

除了星期天，他每天都工作。

Chúle Xīngqītiān, tā měi tiān dōu gōngzuò.

He works every day except Sunday.

The disambiguation is in the second clause: 还/也 = additive (besides A, also B); 都 = exclusive (everything except A). 以外 is optional and slightly more formal.

Pattern 8 · 越来越 — More and More 越来越

Structure: 越来越 + Adjective / Verb

Meaning: Gradual change in one direction over time

我的汉语越来越好了。

Wǒ de Hànyǔ yuèlái yuè hǎo le.

My Chinese is getting better and better.

天气越来越冷了。

Tiānqì yuèlái yuè lěng le.

The weather is getting colder and colder.

他越来越不想去了。

Tā yuèlái yuè bù xiǎng qù le.

He's less and less willing to go.

The sentence-final 了 marks the change of state and is common but not required. 越来越 can take negated predicates (越来越不…) to express progressive decrease.

Pattern 9 · 越A越B — The More A, The More B 越…越…

Structure: 越 + A + 越 + B

Meaning: As A increases/intensifies, B also increases/intensifies

Both A and B can be adjectives or verbs. The two clauses can share the same subject or have different subjects. This expresses a proportional or correlated relationship.

这本书越看越有意思。

Zhè běn shū yuè kàn yuè yǒuyìsi.

The more you read this book, the more interesting it gets.

他越说越快，我越听越不懂。

Tā yuè shuō yuè kuài, wǒ yuè tīng yuè bù dǒng.

The faster he spoke, the less I understood.

越早学，越容易。

Yuè zǎo xué, yuè róngyì.

The earlier you learn, the easier it is.

Distinguish from 越来越: 越来越 compares now vs. a previous state over time (getting more and more X); 越A越B correlates two things proportionally (as A changes, B changes accordingly).

Pattern 10 · 连…都/也 — Even…Also 连…都/也

Structure: 连 + [extreme case] + 都/也 + Verb

Meaning: If even this extreme case is true, everything else certainly is

连 highlights the most extreme or unexpected item in a set to make a stronger point. 都 and 也 are interchangeable here; 都 is more common.

他连饭都没吃就去上班了。

Tā lián fàn dōu méi chī jiù qù shàngbān le.

He went to work without even eating.

这道题连老师也不会。

Zhè dào tí lián lǎoshī yě bù huì.

Even the teacher can't do this problem.

我连他的名字都忘了。

Wǒ lián tā de míngzi dōu wàng le.

I even forgot his name.

The 连 element is usually placed before the verb's object (the focused item). The rest of the predicate follows 都/也. Negation appears before the verb, after 都/也: 连…都没/不…

Pattern 11 · 一边…一边 — Doing Two Things Simultaneously 一边…一边

Structure: 一边 + Verb₁, 一边 + Verb₂

Meaning: Two actions are happening at the same time

他一边听音乐，一边做作业。

Tā yībiān tīng yīnyuè, yībiān zuò zuòyè.

He listens to music while doing homework.

我们一边走，一边聊天。

Wǒmen yībiān zǒu, yībiān liáotiānr.

We chatted while walking.

一边…一边 requires both verbs to be ongoing actions. Do not use it for instantaneous or sequential actions.
Compare with: 先…然后 (sequential) and V着 V (manner + main verb).

For two simultaneous states rather than actions, use 又…又… (Pattern 22): 这道菜又辣又好吃 (This dish is both spicy and delicious).

Pattern 12 · 先…然后 — First…Then 先…然后

Structure: 先 + Verb ₁ , 然后 + Verb ₂	Meaning: Two actions in sequence; first one, then the other
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你先吃饭，然后再出发。

Nǐ xiān chīfàn, ránhòu zài chūfā.

Eat first, then set off.

我先查一下词典，然后再告诉你。

Wǒ xiān chá yīxià cídiǎn, ránhòu zài gàosu nǐ.

I'll look it up first, then tell you.

再 in the second clause (然后再) adds the nuance of 'only after that'. It's common but optional. 先 alone can mark the first action without 然后.

Pattern 13 · 刚 / 刚才 / 刚刚 — Just Now 刚

刚	gāng	Adverb: modifies verb directly; "just did"	他刚走。He just left.
刚才	gāngcái	Time noun: "a moment ago"; can be topic	刚才有人来。Someone came just now.
刚刚	gānggāng	Emphatic adverb: "just this very moment"	他刚刚出门。He just walked out this second.

你刚才说什么？

Nǐ gāngcái shuō shénme?

What did you say just now?

我刚到家。

Wǒ gāng dào jiā.

I just got home.

刚才 can appear at the start of a sentence as a time topic (刚才他说了…). 刚 and 刚刚 are pure adverbs and must precede the verb. Do not add 了 after 刚 — 他刚走了 sounds redundant; 他刚走 is cleaner.

Pattern 14 · 终于 — Finally / At Last 终于

Structure: 终于 + Verb/Adjective

Meaning: Something long-awaited or difficult has finally happened

终于 carries an emotional tone of relief, satisfaction, or exasperation after a long wait or struggle. It always refers to something that has now materialised.

我终于学会了！

Wǒ zhōngyú xué huì le!

I finally learned it!

他终于把作业做完了。

Tā zhōngyú bǎ zuòyè zuò wán le.

He finally finished his homework.

经过三年，他终于通过了HSK四级。

Jīngguò sān nián, tā zhōngyú tōngguò le HSK sì jí.

After three years, he finally passed HSK 4.

终于 contrasts with 最后 (zuihòu, 'in the end / lastly'). 最后 is neutral and sequential; 终于 carries emotional weight and implies the outcome was the result of effort, patience, or waiting.

Pattern 15 · 一直 — Continuously / All Along 一直

Structure: 一直 + Verb / Adjective

Meaning: Unbroken continuation of an action or state

他一直在等你。

Tā yīzhí zài děng nǐ.

He has been waiting for you all along.

我一直喜欢学中文。

Wǒ yīzhí xǐhuan xué Zhōngwén.

I have always liked studying Chinese.

一直走，看到银行就右转。

Yīzhí zǒu, kàndào yínháng jiù yòu zhuǎn.

Go straight, and turn right when you see the bank.

一直 has two main uses: (1) temporal continuity — an action/state that has been uninterrupted; (2) directional continuity — going straight (in a direction). Context and the nature of the verb disambiguate.

Pattern 16 · 从来 (+ Negation) — Never / Always 从来

从来 + 不/没 — 'never' (across all time up to now)

Structure: 从来 + 不 + Verb (habits) / 从来 + 没(有) + Verb (past events)

Meaning: Something has never happened or is never done

我从来不喝酒。

Wǒ cónglái bù hē jiǔ.

I never drink alcohol. (habitual)

她从来没去过国外。

Tā cónglái méi qù guò guówài.

She has never been abroad.

从来不 = habitual negation (I never do X as a rule); 从来没(有) = experiential negation (I have never done X in my life). Match the pattern to your meaning.

Pattern 17 · 应该 vs. 必须 — Should vs. Must 应该 vs. 必须

应该 (yīnggāi) — moral or logical 'should'

你应该多锻炼。

Nǐ yīnggāi duō duànliàn.

You should exercise more.

我们应该注意安全。

Wǒmen yīnggāi zhùyì ānquán.

We should pay attention to safety.

必须 (bìxū) — obligation, no choice

你必须现在出发。

Nǐ bìxū xiànzài chūfā.

You must set off now.

参加考试必须带身份证。

Cānjiā kǎoshì bìxū dài shēnfènzhèng.

You must bring your ID to take the exam.

应该	不应该	shouldn't; ought not to
必须	不必/不用	don't need to; not necessary
必须	不能	must not (prohibition)

不必 (bùbì) = it's not necessary (you have a choice); 不能 = you are not allowed / it's impossible (no choice). Do not confuse them — they carry very different social weight.

Pattern 18 · 认为 vs. 觉得 — Think / Believe / Feel 认为 vs. 觉得

Both verbs introduce opinions, but they differ in register and degree of certainty. 认为 presents a considered judgment; 觉得 expresses a feeling or impression.

认为 rènwéi	Formal/neutral	High — a held belief	considered opinions, arguments

觉得 juéde	Colloquial	Lower — a feeling/impression	personal reactions, sensations
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我认为这个方法不对。

Wǒ rènwéi zhège fāngfǎ bú duì.

I believe this method is wrong.

我觉得有点累。

Wǒ juéde yǒudiǎn lèi.

I feel a bit tired.

觉得 can be followed directly by an adjective (觉得累/热/不舒服), while 认为 typically requires a clause. 以为 (yǐwéi) is a third verb meaning 'mistakenly think' — it implies the belief turned out to be wrong.

Pattern 19 · 好像 / 看来 — Seems Like / Apparently 好像 / 看来

好像 (hǎoxiàng) — resembles; seems as if

Structure: 好像 + Clause / 好像 + Noun	Meaning: Resemblance or tentative judgment based on impression
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他好像生病了。

Tā hǎoxiàng shēngbìng le.

He seems to be sick.

这个问题好像很简单。

Zhège wèntí hǎoxiàng hěn jiǎndān.

This problem seems quite simple.

看来 (kànlái) — it looks like; apparently (speaker's inference)

Structure: 看来 + Clause	Meaning: Speaker's inference from available evidence
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看来他不打算来了。

Kànlái tā bù dǎsuàn lái le.

It looks like he doesn't plan to come.

看来今天要下雨。

Kànlái jīntiān yào xià yǔ.

It looks like it's going to rain today.

好像 focuses on visual/perceptual resemblance or a vague impression; 看来 signals the speaker is drawing a logical conclusion from observed evidence. 看来 typically opens the sentence; 好像 can appear anywhere in the predicate.

Pattern 20 · 其实 / 实际上 — Actually / In Fact 其实

Structure: 其实, Clause

Meaning: Corrects a misconception or introduces a less obvious truth

他看起来很严肃，其实非常有幽默感。

Tā kànqǐlái hěn yánsù, qíshí fēicháng yǒu yōumògǎn.

He looks serious, but actually has a great sense of humor.

其实这道菜不难做。

Qíshí zhè dào cài bù nán zuò.

Actually, this dish isn't hard to make.

其实 is conversational; 实际上 (shíjìshàng) is more formal and appears more in written Chinese. Both introduce a reality that contrasts with the expected or stated view.

Pattern 21 · 大概 / 差不多 — Approximately / Almost 大概 / 差不多

大概 (dàgài) — roughly, probably (degree of certainty)

他大概三十岁。

Tā dàgài sānshí suì.

He's probably about thirty.

大概需要两个小时。

Dàgài xūyào liǎng gè xiǎoshí.

It'll probably take about two hours.

差不多 (chàbuduō) — almost, nearly, similar (degree of completeness or similarity)

我们差不多到了。

Wǒmen chàbuduō dào le.

We're almost there.

这两件衣服差不多，很难选。

Zhè liǎng jiàn yīfu chàbuduō, hěn nán xuǎn.

These two items of clothing are pretty similar; it's hard to choose.

大概 hedges the speaker's certainty about a claim (I'm not sure, but probably X). 差不多 hedges proximity or degree (not quite there yet, or nearly the same). They are not freely interchangeable.

Pattern 22 · 又…又… — Both…And… 又…又…

Structure: 又 + Adj/V₁ + 又 + Adj/V₂

Meaning: Two simultaneous qualities or actions of the same kind

又…又… coordinates two adjectives or verbs that are typically in the same semantic category (both positive, both negative, or both neutral). Unlike 一边…一边, it describes states rather than ongoing parallel actions.

他又高又帅。

Tā yòu gāo yòu shuài.

He's both tall and handsome.

这道菜又辣又咸，我不喜欢。

Zhè dào cài yòu là yòu xián, wǒ bù xǐhuan.

This dish is both spicy and salty; I don't like it.

他又唱又跳，很开心。

Tā yòu chàng yòu tiào, hěn kāixīn.

He was singing and dancing, very happy.

Do NOT mix positive and negative poles: 又好又不好 is incoherent. For contrasting qualities, use 虽然…但是 or 既…又. For two simultaneous ongoing actions, use 一边…一边.

Pattern 23 · 为了 — In Order To / For the Purpose Of 为了

Structure: 为了 + Goal, Subject + Verb

Meaning: States the purpose of an action

为了学好中文，我每天早上五点起床学习。

Wèile xué hǎo Zhōngwén, wǒ měi tiān zǎoshang wǔ diǎn qǐchuáng xuéxí.

In order to learn Chinese well, I get up at 5 AM every day to study.

他为了通过考试，放弃了很多休息时间。

Tā wèile tōngguò kǎoshì, fàngqì le hěnduō xiūxi shíjiān.

In order to pass the exam, he gave up a lot of rest time.

为了 expresses purpose (forward-looking intention). Because of (backward-looking cause) is 因为. A useful test: 为了 answers 'why do/will you do X?'; 因为 answers 'why did X happen?'

Pattern 24 · 根据 / 按照 — According To / Based On 根据 / 按照

根据 (gēnjù) — based on evidence or data

根据天气预报，明天会下雨。

Gēnjù tiānqì yùbào, míngtiān huì xià yǔ.

According to the weather forecast, it'll rain tomorrow.

根据我的经验，这个方法最有效。

Gēnjù wǒ de jīngyàn, zhège fāngfǎ zuì yǒuxiào.

Based on my experience, this method is the most effective.

按照 (ànzhào) — following rules, instructions, or a plan

请按照规定填写表格。

Qǐng ànzhào guīdìng tiánxiě biǎogé.

Please fill in the form according to the regulations.

根据 is used when citing evidence, data, or reasoning as the basis for a claim. 按照 is used when following a set procedure, rule, or instruction. Both are prepositional and appear sentence-initially or before the subject.

Pattern 25 · 通过 — Through / By Means Of 通过

通过 as a preposition — 'by means of'

Structure: 通过 + Method/Channel, Subject + Verb	Meaning: Achieving something via a particular means or channel
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通过练习，我的口语越来越好。

Tōngguò liànxí, wǒ de kǒuyǔ yuèláiyuè hǎo.

Through practice, my spoken Chinese is getting better and better.

他通过朋友找到了这份工作。

Tā tōngguò péngyou zhǎodào le zhè fèn gōngzuò.

He found this job through a friend.

通过 as a verb — 'to pass; to approve'

他通过了HSK三级考试。

Tā tōngguò le HSK sān jí kǎoshì.

He passed the HSK Level 3 exam.

通过 as a preposition precedes a noun/verb phrase denoting the method. As a verb it takes a direct object (通过考试, 通过决定). Do not confuse with 经过 (jīngguò, to pass by a place / to go through a process).

Pattern 26 · Resultative Verb Complements 结果补语

A resultative complement is a second verb (or adjective) attached to the main verb to describe the result achieved. Unlike degree complements (V + 得 + Adj), these are fused directly onto the verb with no 得 in between.

做完 zuò wán	finish doing	我做完作业了。I finished the homework.
写好 xiě hǎo	write well/finish writing	信写好了。The letter is written.
听懂 tīng dǒng	understand by listening	你听懂了吗？Did you understand?
看见 kàn jiàn	see (successfully)	我看见他了。I saw him.
找到 zhǎo dào	find successfully	找到了！Found it!
学会 xué huì	learn and master	你学会了吗？Have you mastered it?
买错 mǎi cuò	buy the wrong thing	我买错了。I bought the wrong one.
说清楚 shuō qīngchu	explain clearly	你说清楚一点。Explain more clearly.

Potential form: V + 得/不 + Result

Insert 得 or 不 between the main verb and result to express ability/possibility:

这本书我看得懂。 / 我看不懂。

Zhè běn shū wǒ kàn de dǒng. / Wǒ kàn bu dǒng.

I can understand this book. / I can't understand it.

时间来不及了，做不完了。

Shíjiān láibují le, zuò bu wán le.

There's no time left; I can't finish.

The potential form V得Result/V不Result does NOT use 了. The actual result form DOES use 了 to mark completion: 做完了 (done) vs. 做得完 (can finish).

Pattern 27 · 不管…都 — Regardless Of 不管…都

Structure: 不管 + Condition + 都 + Result

Meaning: The result holds no matter what the condition is

不管天气怎么样，我都去跑步。

Bùguǎn tiānqì zěnmeyàng, wǒ dōu qù pǎobù.

Regardless of the weather, I go running.

不管多难，他都不放弃。

Bùguǎn duō nán, tā dōu bù fàngqì.

No matter how hard it is, he never gives up.

不管你去不去，我都去。

Bùguǎn nǐ qù bu qù, wǒ dōu qù.

Whether you go or not, I'm going.

不管 takes question-word phrases (怎么样, 什么, 多+Adj, A不A) as its condition. 无论 (wúlùn) is a formal written synonym. 都 in the result clause is mandatory — it collapses all possible conditions to one outcome.

Pattern 28 · 既然…就 — Since (It's Already the Case That)...

既然…就

Structure: 既然 + Established fact, 就 + Logical conclusion

Meaning: Draws a conclusion from a situation the listener has already accepted

既然 acknowledges a fact that both speaker and listener already know to be true, then draws a logical or pragmatic consequence. It is not a hypothesis (like 如果) — the premise is real and accepted.

既然你不想去，就别去了。

Jìrán nǐ bù xiǎng qù, jiù bié qù le.

Since you don't want to go, just don't.

既然决定了，就要努力做好。

Jìrán juéding le, jiù yào nǔlì zuò hǎo.

Since the decision is made, we should do our best.

既然 vs. 如果: 如果 = hypothesis (might or might not be true); 既然 = acknowledged reality (already the case, we both know it). Using 既然 for something not yet established sounds strange.

Quick Reference Summary

把	S + 把 + O + V + Complement	Disposal: do something to a specific object; verb needs result/direction
被	S + 被 + Agent + V + Result	Passive: typically undesirable outcome; agent optional
才	Context + 才 + V	Later/less than expected; contrast with 就 (earlier/more than expected)
只有…才	只有 + Cond + 才 + Result	Necessary condition: the only way
只要…就	只要 + Cond + 就 + Result	Sufficient condition: this one way is enough
如果…就	如果 + Cond, 就 + Result	Hypothesis; 的话 appended to condition = softer form
不但…而且	不但 + A, 而且 + B	Not only A but also B; B escalates A
除了…还	除了 + A, 还/也 + B	Besides A, also B (inclusive); 除了…都 = except A (exclusive)
越来越	越来越 + Adj/V	Progressive change over time; + 了 common
越A越B	越 + A + 越 + B	Proportional correlation; not the same as 越来越
连…都/也	连 + Extreme case + 都/也 + V	Highlights the most unexpected case to strengthen a point
一边…一边	一边 + V ₁ , 一边 + V ₂	Two simultaneous ongoing actions
先…然后	先 + V ₁ , 然后 + V ₂	Sequential actions; 然后再 = only after that
刚/刚才	刚 + V (adv) / 刚才 (time noun)	Just now; 刚 = adverb, 刚才 = topic noun
终于	终于 + V	Finally (emotional relief/satisfaction); ≠ 最后 (neutral sequence)
一直	一直 + V	Unbroken continuation of action/state; also directional continuity
从来	从来 + 不/没 + V	从来不 = habitual never; 从来没 = experiential never
应该/必须	应该 + V / 必须 + V	应该 = moral should; 必须 = obligation. Negations differ!

认为/觉得	认为 + Clause / 觉得 + Adj/Clause	认为 = held belief; 觉得 = feeling/impression; 以为 = mistaken belief
好像/看来	好像 + Clause / 看来 + Clause	好像 = resemblance/impression; 看来 = inference from evidence
其实	其实, Clause	Corrects a misconception; 实际上 = formal equivalent
大概/差不多	大概 + Clause / 差不多 + V	大概 = certainty hedge; 差不多 = proximity/similarity hedge
又…又…	又 + A + 又 + B	Two simultaneous same-pole qualities/actions
为了	为了 + Goal, S + V	Purpose (forward); contrast with 因为 (backward-looking cause)
根据/按照	根据 + Evidence / 按照 + Rule	根据 = based on data; 按照 = following rules/instructions
通过	通过 + Method, V / 通过 + Exam	Preposition: by means of; Verb: to pass/approve
结果补语	V + Result / V + 得/不 + Result	Actual result (+ 了); Potential (得/不, no 了)
不管…都	不管 + Question-word phrase + 都 + V	Regardless of; 都 mandatory; 无论 = formal synonym
既然…就	既然 + Known fact, 就 + Conclusion	Since (accepted reality) → conclusion; ≠ 如果 (hypothesis)